

MY STORY

A Life Book for Children in Foster Care

By Daniel Tesfamariam

This book belongs to:

A MESSAGE TO MY GROWN-UPS

Dear foster parent, caseworker, or caring adult:

This life book helps children in foster care:

- Preserve their personal history and memories
- Process feelings about transitions and placements
- Maintain connection to their identity and story
- Express questions and emotions in a safe way
- Feel validated that their experiences matter

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK:

- Let the child lead. Never force them to fill in pages.
- Some pages may bring up big feelings - that's okay.
- Offer to write for younger children.
- Revisit pages as the child grows and understands more.
- This is THEIR book. They decide what goes in it.

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ALL ABOUT ME

My name is:

My birthday is:

I am ____ years old

My favorite color:

My favorite food:

My favorite animal:

My favorite song:

My favorite game:

My favorite subject in school:

Things I'm good at:

I am happiest when:

When I grow up I want to be:

MY FAMILY

All the people who are important to me

People who are important to me (draw or write):

Name: _____ Who they are to me: _____

Something I love about them: _____

Name: _____ Who they are to me: _____

Something I love about them: _____

Name: _____ Who they are to me: _____

Something I love about them: _____

Name: _____ Who they are to me: _____

Something I love about them: _____

Name: _____ Who they are to me: _____

Something I love about them: _____

Name: _____ Who they are to me: _____

Something I love about them: _____

Name: _____ Who they are to me: _____

Something I love about them: _____

Name: _____ Who they are to me: _____

Something I love about them: _____

WHERE I'VE LIVED

These are the places I have called home:

Place 1: _____

When: _____ I was ____ years old

Something I remember: _____

How I felt: _____

Place 2: _____

When: _____ I was ____ years old

Something I remember: _____

How I felt: _____

Place 3: _____

When: _____ I was ____ years old

Something I remember: _____

How I felt: _____

Place 4: _____

When: _____ I was ____ years old

Something I remember: _____

How I felt: _____

Place 5: _____

When: _____ I was ____ years old

Something I remember: _____

How I felt: _____

Place 6: _____

When: _____ I was ____ years old

Something I remember: _____

How I felt: _____

MY SCHOOL

Current school: _____

Grade: _____ Teacher: _____

My best friend at school: _____

Subjects I like: _____

Subjects I find hard: _____

What I like about my school: _____

OTHER SCHOOLS I'VE BEEN TO:

School: _____ Grade: _____

School: _____ Grade: _____

School: _____ Grade: _____

School: _____ Grade: _____

THINGS I LOVE TO DO

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____

The thing that makes me happiest is:

MY FEELINGS

It's okay to feel ALL of these feelings:

HAPPY I feel this when: _____

SAD I feel this when: _____

ANGRY I feel this when: _____

SCARED I feel this when: _____

CONFUSED I feel this when: _____

LONELY I feel this when: _____

EXCITED I feel this when: _____

WORRIED I feel this when: _____

LOVED I feel this when: _____

HOPEFUL I feel this when: _____

Right now I mostly feel: _____

And that's okay.

QUESTIONS I HAVE

It's okay to have questions. You can write them here.

You can ask a safe adult to help you find answers.

MY WISHES & DREAMS

If I could wish for anything:

Wish 1: _____

Wish 2: _____

Wish 3: _____

When I grow up, I dream of:

Something I want to do this year:

Something I want to learn:

PEOPLE WHO HELP ME

My caseworker: _____ Phone: _____

My therapist/counselor: _____ Phone: _____

My CASA/advocate: _____ Phone: _____

My foster parent(s): _____ Phone: _____

My teacher: _____ School: _____

My doctor: _____ Phone: _____

Other important person: _____ Phone: _____

If I need help, I can call: _____

If it's an emergency, I call: 911

LETTERS I WANT TO WRITE

Dear _____,

From, _____

THINGS I WANT TO REMEMBER

Happy memories, things people said, or things I don't want to forget:

MY STRENGTHS & SUPERPOWERS

I am STRONG because I have been through hard things.

My superpowers:

Power 1: _____

Power 2: _____

Power 3: _____

Power 4: _____

Power 5: _____

Power 6: _____

Power 7: _____

Power 8: _____

Things other people say I'm good at:

I am proud of myself for:

WHAT I NEED OTHERS TO KNOW ABOUT ME

If there's one thing I want grown-ups to understand:

What helps me when I'm upset:

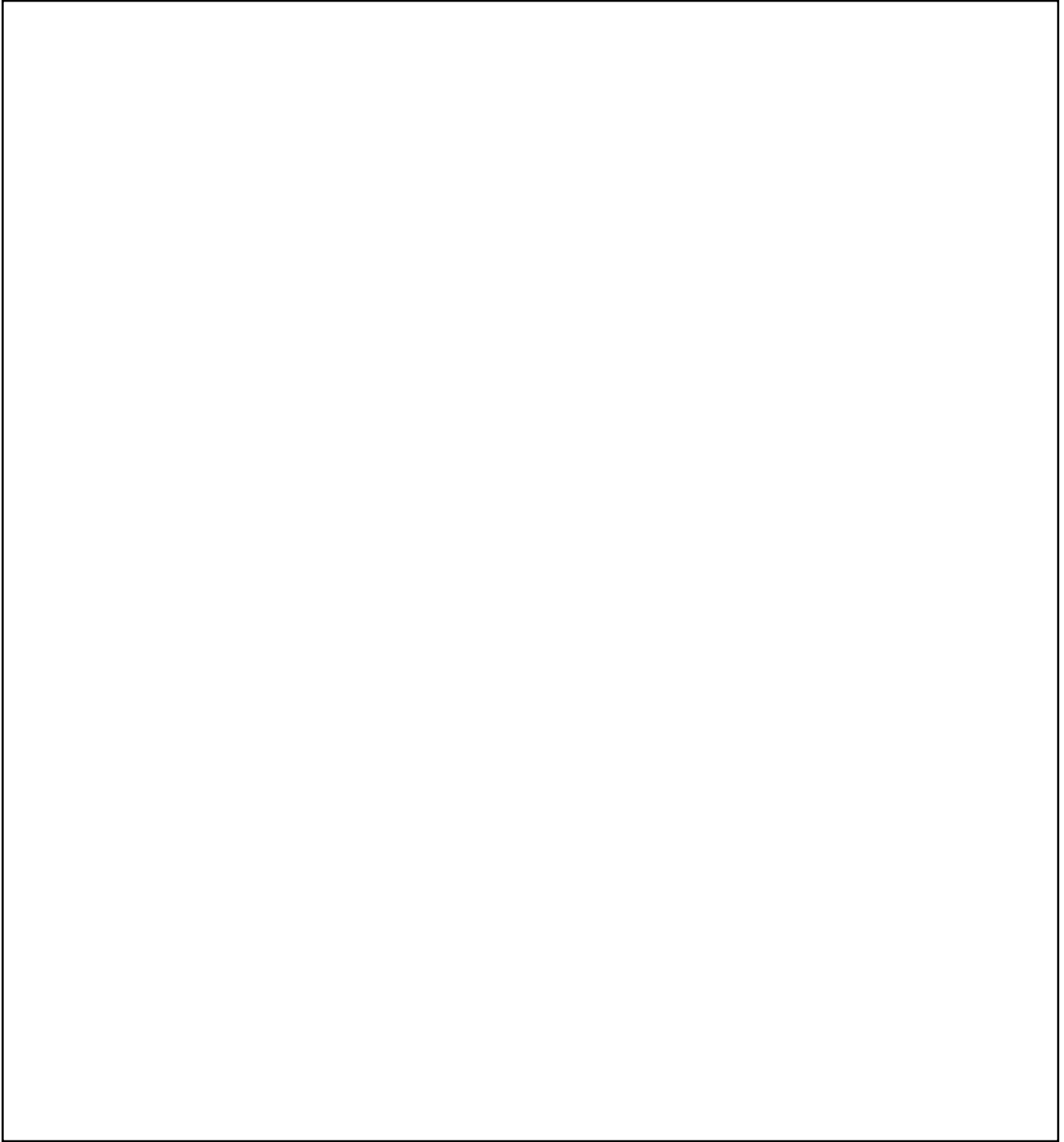
What does NOT help when I'm upset:

Things I need to feel safe:

My biggest hope right now:

PICTURES OF ME

Paste a photo or draw a picture here:

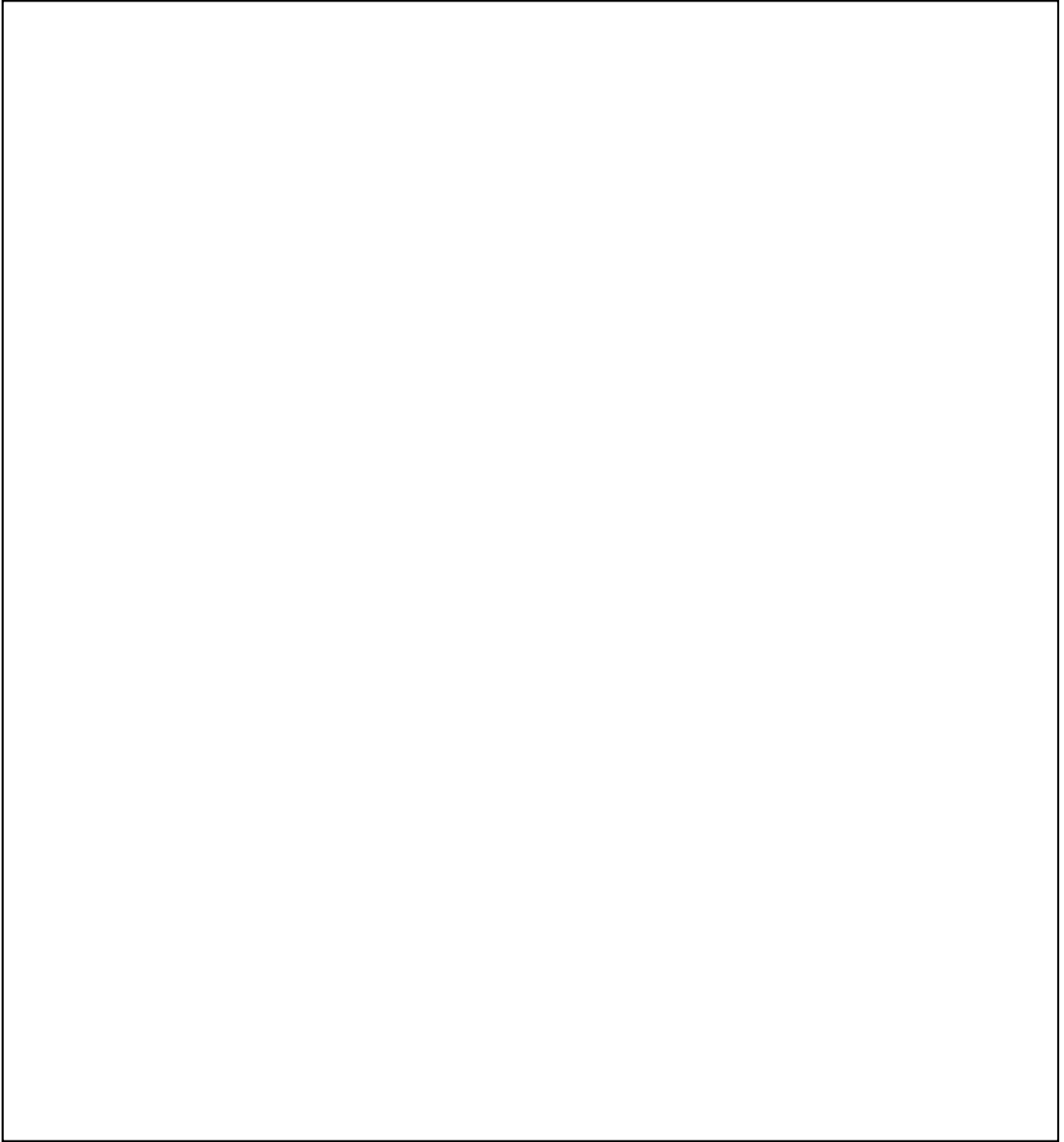


Caption: _____

Date: _____

PICTURES OF MY FAMILY

Paste a photo or draw a picture here:

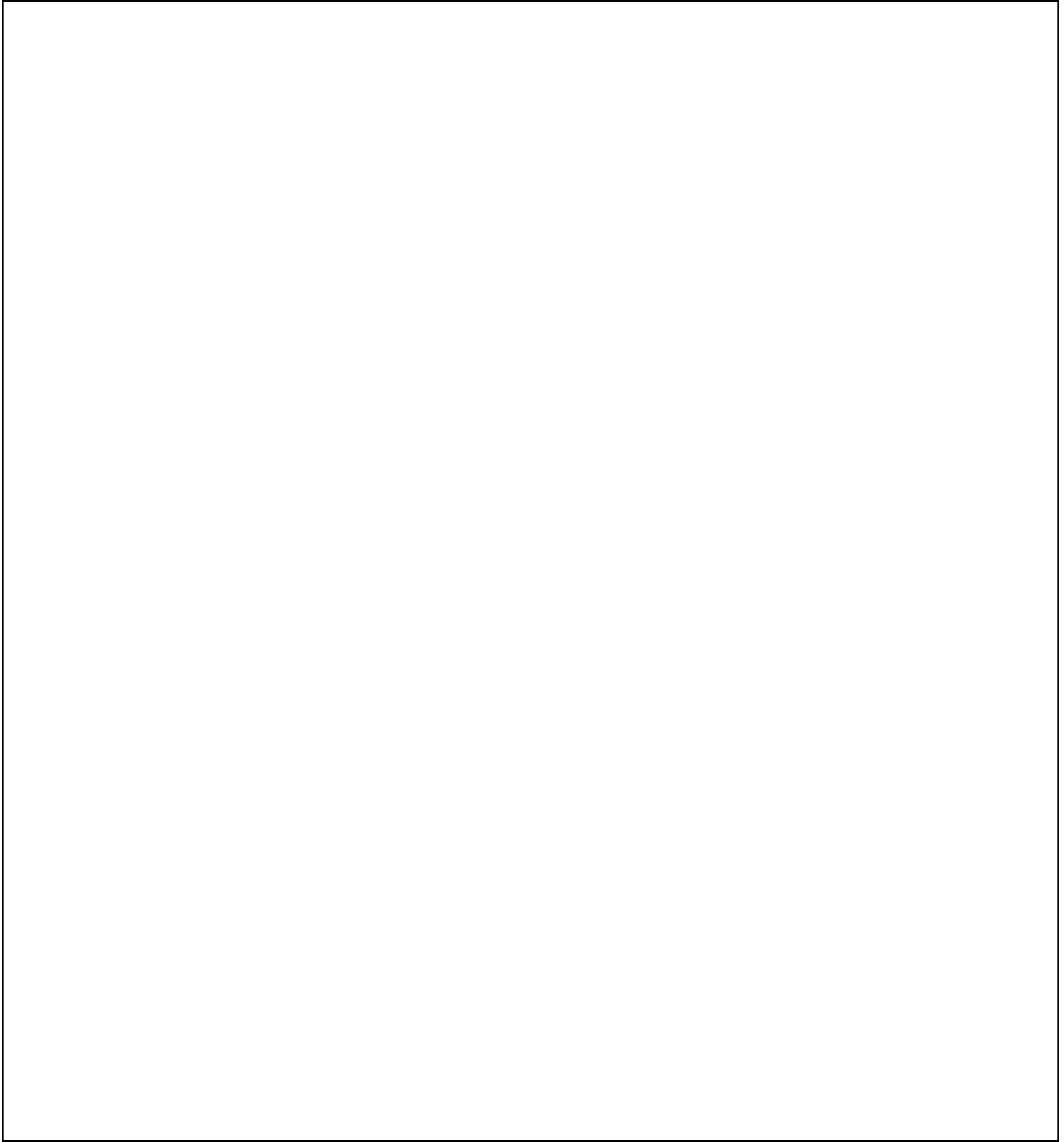


Caption: _____

Date: _____

PICTURES OF MY FRIENDS

Paste a photo or draw a picture here:

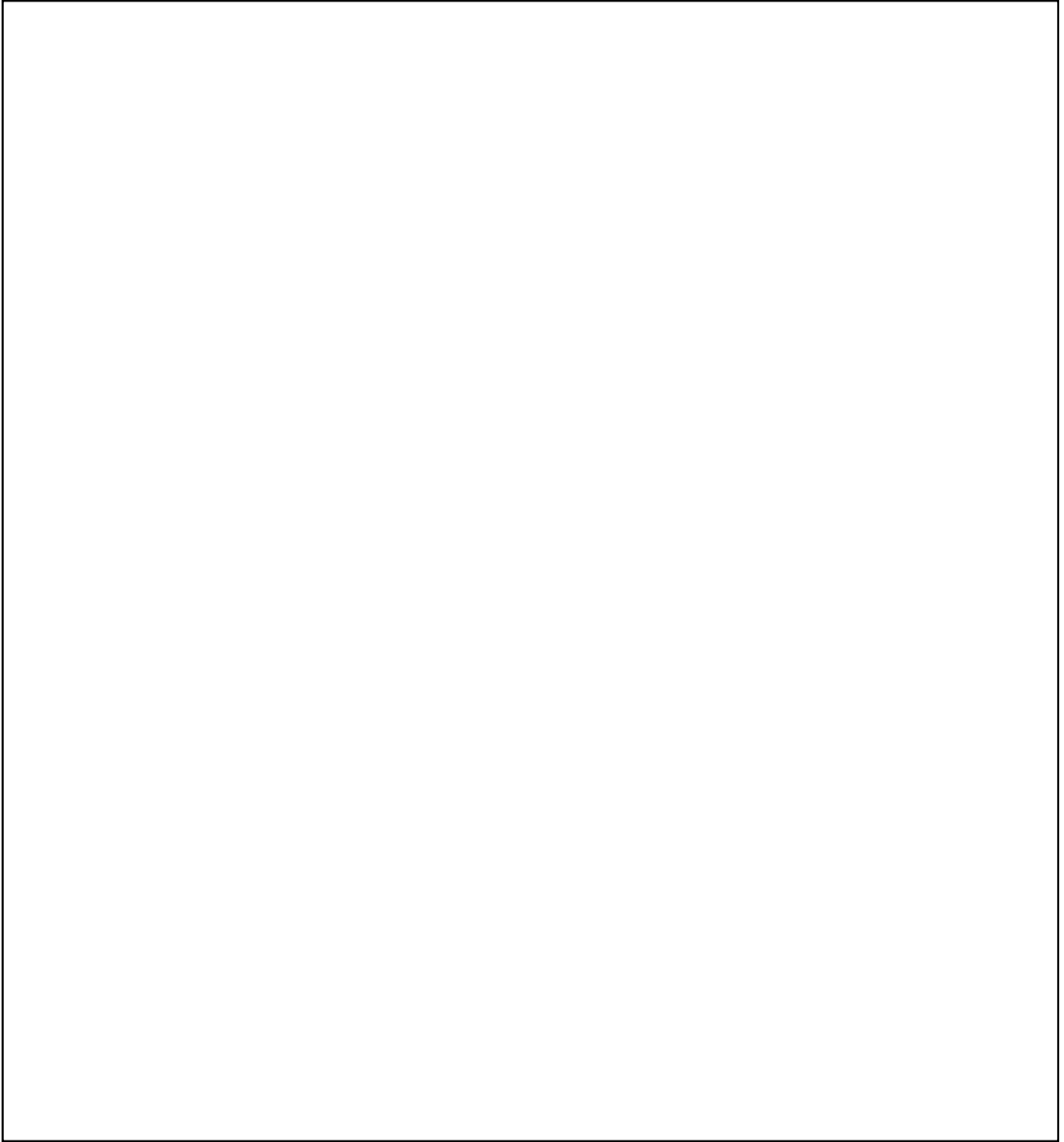


Caption: _____

Date: _____

PICTURES OF MY PETS

Paste a photo or draw a picture here:

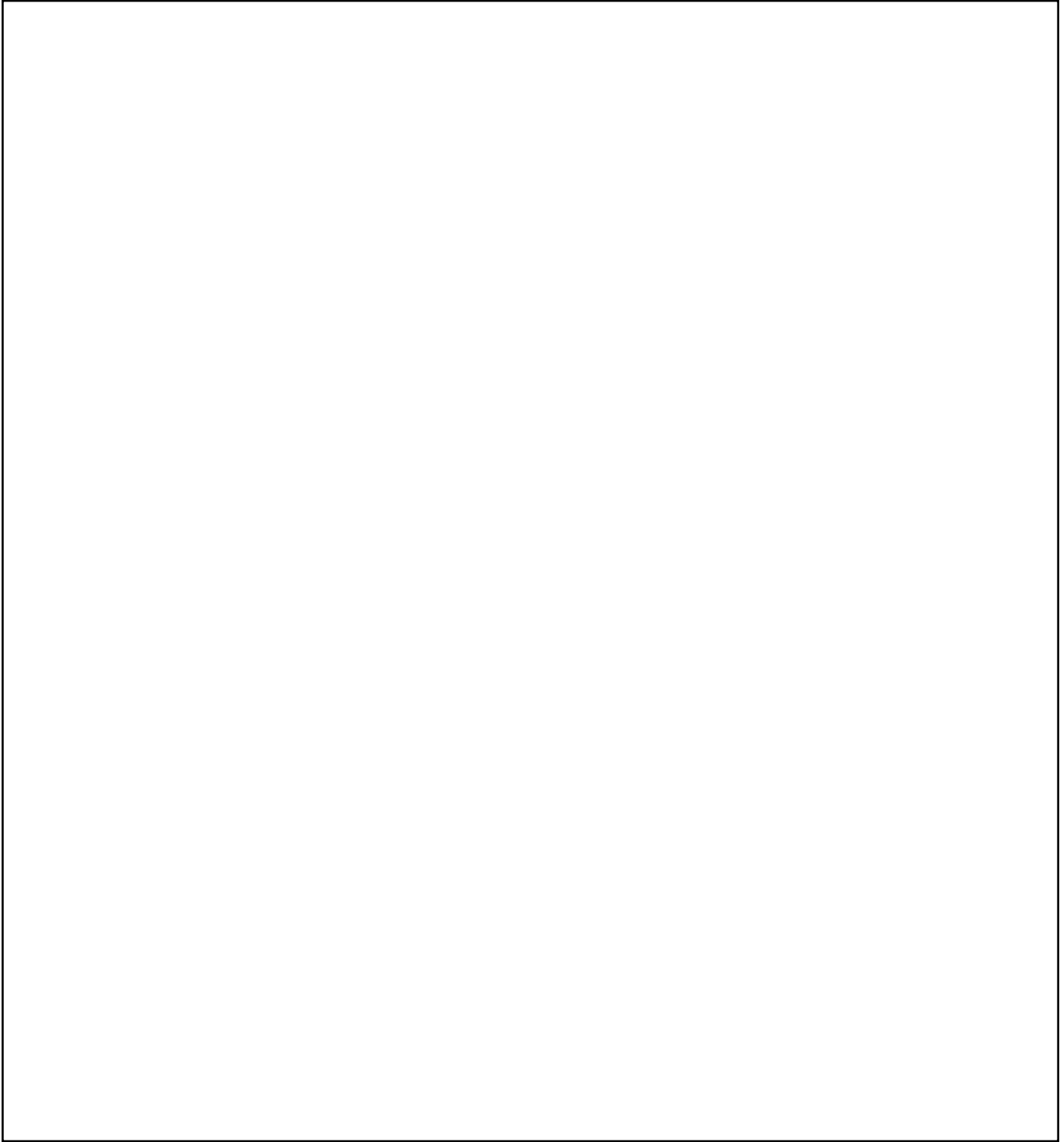


Caption: _____

Date: _____

MY FAVORITE DRAWING

Paste a photo or draw a picture here:



Caption: _____

Date: _____

YOU ARE BRAVE AND LOVED

You are BRAVE.

You are STRONG.

You are LOVED.

Your story matters.

YOU matter.